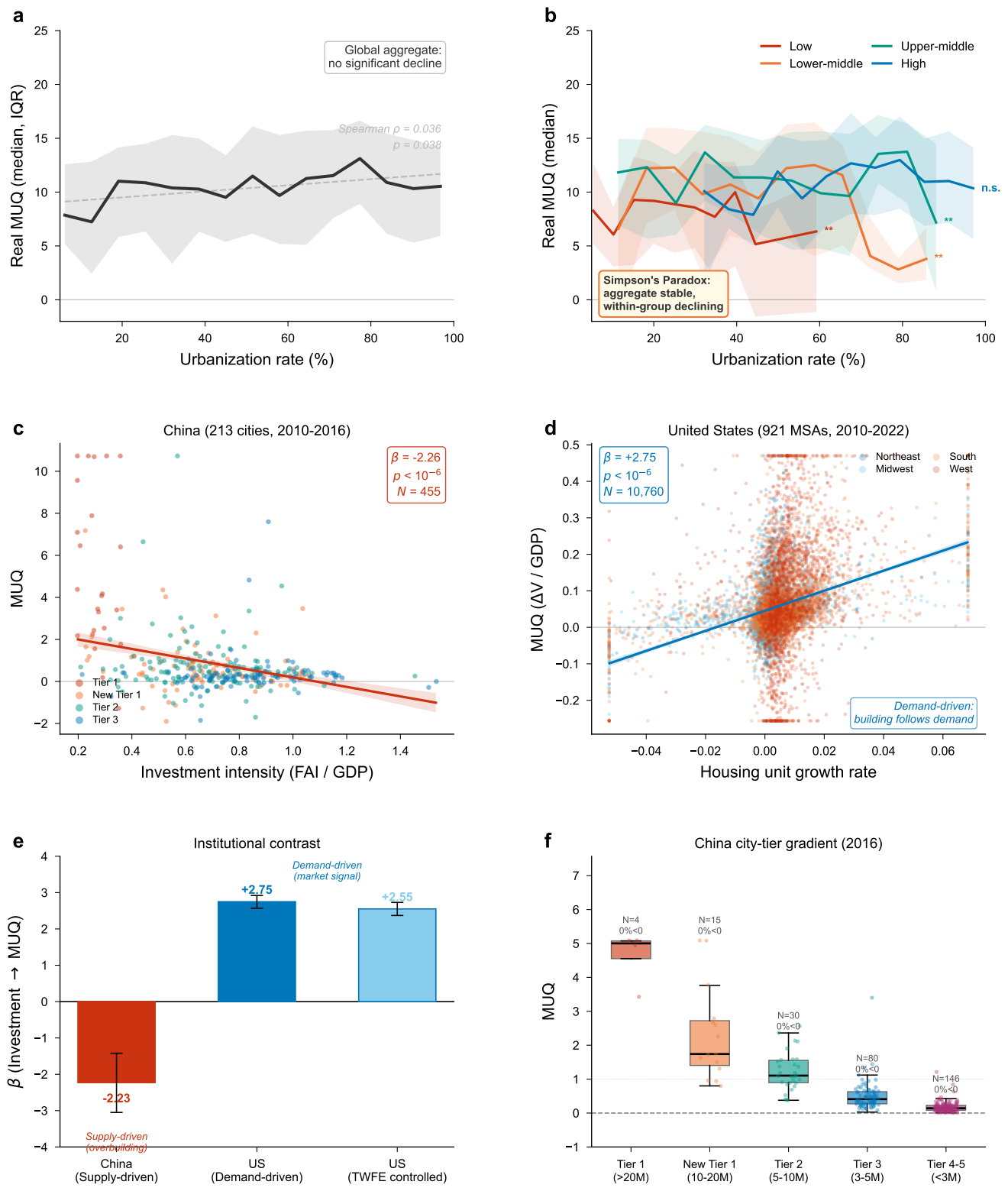
a
Global aggregate:
no significant decline
Spearman ρ = 0.036
p = 0.038
Real MUQ (median, IQR)
Urbanization rate (%)
b
Low
Lower-middle
Upper-middle
High
Real MUQ (median)
n.s.
**
Simpson's Paradox:
aggregate stable,
within-group declining
Urbanization rate (%)
c
China (213 cities, 2010-2016)
β = -2.26
p < 10^−6
N = 455
MUQ
Tier 1
New Tier 1
Tier 2
Tier 3
Investment intensity (FAI / GDP)
d
United States (921 MSAs, 2010-2022)
β = +2.75
p < 10^−6
N = 10,760
Northeast
Midwest
South
West
MUQ (ΔV / GDP)
Demand-driven:
building follows demand
Housing unit growth rate
e
Institutional contrast
Demand-driven
(market signal)
+2.75
+2.55
-2.23
Supply-driven
(overbuilding)
β (Investment → MUQ)
China
(Supply-driven)
US
(Demand-driven)
US
(TWFE controlled)
f
China city-tier gradient (2016)
N=4
0%<0
N=15
0%<0
N=30
0%<0
N=80
0%<0
N=146
0%<0
MUQ
Tier 1
(>20M)
New Tier 1
(10-20M)
Tier 2
(5-10M)
Tier 3
(3-5M)
Tier 4-5
(<3M)